Meow

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/46187377.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

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F/F, F/M

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by NeurodivergentCatra

Summary

In a universe where the sword never existed, She-Ra never existed, and Adora dies during their escape from the Horde, Catra finds herself alone in the forest for a year. Until Bow and Glimmer come along, anyway.

A New Home

The Horde had not been kind to Catra. When she and Adora had their chance to escape, they took it. Adora had just gotten promoted to Force Captain, and used her new title to steal a skiff. They booked it into the Whispering Woods. Unfortunately, the skiff crashed.

///// POV Catra

It had been a long time since the accident, and all that I had left of Adora was her jacket. I hadn't taken it off since I buried her. However, with so much time alone in the Woods, no shelter and the only food being what few animals I could find that were smaller and/or weaker than I was (Mostly rabbit, that was my favorite), I became a lot less civilized. I knew I could still speak human tongues if I wanted to, but I never did. Until one day, when I got a little too close to a town, some wandering teenagers found me. I had been enjoying a rabbit, when they accidentally walked into the clearing. They were teenagers, like me (or at least I think I was still a teenager, it had been hard to keep track of time all alone in the deep forest). The one who smelled of magic was mostly pink, about the height I would be if she stood on two legs instead of four, like I had grown accustomed to in the forest. The other was a taller boy, wearing a gold crop top and holding a bow.

"Bow, I've never seen something like that." the girl whispered.

"Me neither." Bow whispered back, unaware that I could clearly hear them. Bow slowly lowered himself to his knees, and reached

out his hand. “Here, kitty. I won’t hurt you.” he stated calmly. I glared at him, unsure of what to do.

“Bow, what are you doing?” the magic girl asked.

“It’s almost winter! If she stays out here, she’ll freeze to death!” Bow responded. I had noticed it was getting colder, but I also thought my fur would keep me warm enough. However, I was intrigued, so I turned my head to the side.

“She’ll be fine. She’s even got a jacket!” the girl argued. Once she realized what she had said, she looked back at Catra. “Bow, that cat is wearing a jacket.”

“You just noticed?” He asked, breaking into laughter.

“Bow, look at the jacket!” She yelled. I backed away from her, unused to loud voices.

“Is that a… Is that a Horde Captain’s badge?” Bow murmured.

“Yeah, it is!” she answered.

“I wonder how she got it!” Bow stated, his eyes full of curiosity. “Glimmer, can we keep her?”

“How do you know she’s a girl?” Glimmer asked.

“I dunno. Just a feeling, I guess.” Bow responded.

“Mom will never let me keep her.”

“And you started obeying her… when?”

“Point taken.” Glimmer muttered.

Bow held out his hand to me again, inching closer. “If you come with us, we’ll keep you safe. And feed you.” He murmured.

“I doubt she understands what you’re saying, Bow.” Glimmer muttered. I decided it would be funny if I got closer and let Bow stroke my mane for a moment, just to piss off Glimmer and prove that she was wrong. However, it felt kind of… nice. It reminded me of when Adora used to do that.

“I think she understands it enough. Maybe she was a pet of a Horde Captain and ran away?” Bow theorized. He was far from the truth, but for what little he knew about me I determined he was pretty smart.

“Maybe.” Glimmer responded.

I was more than happy to play along, and hide that I could speak and walk on two legs. Shelter and food? That was an offer I did not want to decline. I decided I would be careful, though. I did not give out her trust easily, even before I had been living in the woods alone for months.

Bow and Glimmer started walking back towards the town. “Come on, kitty! This way!” Bow called. I followed hesitantly.

///// Bow POV

I walked my way into Thaymor. Glimmer and I were here on patrol, as this town was almost always being fought over between the Horde and the Rebellion, but had found no sign of the Horde. Instead, we found an adorable cat-like creature, one that had even followed us into town. We bought fresh fish from one of the local merchants, and our feline companion seemed to love it. My curiosity was overflowing. This creature was so cat-like, but she didn’t look like *anything* I had seen, or even read about. Glimmer and I caught the next transport wagon back to Brightmoon, and our new feline friend was sleeping at my feet.

“She’s so cute!” I cooed. The feline’s ear twitched, and her tail lashed against my leg.

“Looks like she doesn’t like being called cute. She definitely has a lot of personality, especially for something that isn’t human.” Glimmer mentioned.

“You’re right, Glimmer. She fascinates me more and more with everything we learn. Maybe your mom will know something?”

“It’s worth a shot.” Glimmer answered.

///// Bright Moon, hours later, Glimmer POV

I looked back at Bow and the cat, and sighed. I really didn’t want to hear another lecture from Mom, but I agreed with Bow that a lecture would be worth it if we got to keep her. I pushed open the doors to the throne room, and walked in. “Hey, Mom!” I greeted.

“Hello, Glimmer. Any news on Thaymor?”

“No Horde sightings in the area. However, I did find *something* and I really wanna show her to you!” I stated, and Bow led the cat into the room. She meowed peacefully, and sat next to where Bow stood.

“You brought home a wild… wait a minute.” Mom trailed off. “That’s a Magicat!”

“A Magicat?” Bow asked.

“Magicats were a race that lived on Etheria long ago. They even had their own Kingdom, Halfmoon. However, that Kingdom has long since been lost to time, and it was thought that they were extinct. However, it seems at least one lives today, and has reverted to some feral, less civilized form.” Mom explained.

“Wait, there was a civilized nation of these felines!?” Bow questioned, bewilderment evident in his voice. “How come I have never read about them?”

“Well, for starters, the collapse of Halfmoon was recorded back in the time of the First Ones. Any and all texts from that time period are stored and translated in Mystacor.” Mom answered.

“So, what you’re telling me is that this cat me and Bow found is actually an ancient cat that used to be civilized and lived among the First Ones!?” I yelled. The cat lowered its ears, and I realized I had been too loud for her sensitive ears. I quickly murmured an apology.

“Actually, Glimmer, that *would* explain why she understands our language so well, even if she doesn’t speak it. It does, however, raise tons of questions. Are there more Magicats alive today? If there are, how come this is the first sighting since the times of the First Ones?” Bow rambled. I love it when he rambles, it makes him dreamier, somehow.

“You may keep her, so long as she doesn’t make a mess of the castle or attack anyone.” Mom announced.

“Thanks Mom!” I cried, before quickly leading Bow and our new friend to my room.

After all that, I realized we had never given her a name! “Bow, you think there’s a name on that badge?” I asked.

“There’s definitely a name on the badge, but there is only one scenario that the name belongs to her, being that she was a pet of a Horde officer and given that jacket. It could also be that officer’s name, or she could have killed the officer and put on the jacket for all I know. She seems to like wearing clothes at least.” Bow answered.

“That’s fair.”

“What should we call her?” Bow asked.

“I dunno, I kinda like Kitty.”

///// Catra POV

Kitty!? How creative. Then again, the one with a bow was named Bow, so maybe that’s normal for the Rebellion. I really wanted to speak, tell them how ridiculous that name is, but what if they

wouldn’t feed me if they found out? What if they would get mad that I hid it and kick me out? I decided to keep quiet, for now. Then again, it is easier to be called Kitty than half of the things Shadow Weaver used to call me.

“Kitty it is, I guess.” Bow answered.

“I’m gonna go to the kitchen and grab something for us and Kitty to eat. Would you mind watching her while I’m gone?” Glimmer asked.

“No problem!” Bow replied. As soon as she was gone, he sat next to me and began petting my mane again. “So, you’re smart enough to understand us, which means you willingly chose to stay with us. I appreciate it. After all the stress with the war, Glimmer could really use a friend, even if you don’t speak.” Bow whispered. “I guess I could too.”

I began to purr, despite me trying not to. It was nice to have people care for me, to be nice without a reason, like Adora used to be.

Perfuma

Chapter Summary

Bow, Glimmer, and Catra go to Plumeria

/////Glimmer POV

I woke up the next morning, and Kitty was sleeping at my feet. Seeing her startled me, and I fell out of bed with a scream. I teleported back up to the bed, and Kitty was now wide awake. She lowered her ears, as if she was about to be reprimanded. Then I realized something. My bed was hanging from the ceiling, a good seven feet off the ground. "How did you get up here, Kitty?" She jumped down, landing on all fours as she hit the ground. She then turned, and launched herself back into the air to land on my bed. "That's right, cat powers." I murmured. Kitty smiled. She surprised me more and more with everything I learned. Now if only I could get her to take a bath.

///// Bow POV

An emergency meeting was being held in the Conference room, so me, Glimmer, and Kitty went to see what all the fuss was about. The generals all sat around the table.

As soon as we walked in, Queen Angella spoke. "Princess Perfuma of Plumeria has requested aid, again. The Horde has poisoned their land to the point where nothing grows anymore. We are going to evacuate the citizens of Plumeria to our shelters here in Brightmoon."

“We should be fighting, not running!” Glimmer complained.

“So we can lose more soldiers for land that is near dead already? No, Glimmer.”

“Fine.” Glimmer pouted.

“Can we lead the relief mission, at least? It would be nice to go on our first mission with Kitty.” I asked.

Angella glared at Glimmer. “Under no circumstances will you engage the Horde. Do you hear me?”

“Yes, ma’am!”she answered.

“Very well then, I suppose that’s settled.”

/////

“We have to help the people of Plumeria! Running away from the Horde only gives them more territory!” she groaned angrily.

“I know.” I answered. By this point, I knew better than to argue with her. She could be really stubborn. Speaking of stubbornness, Kitty stopped to sniff flowers multiple times, and was barely keeping up, despite being twice as fast as any human if she tried. However, Plumeria was pretty close now. As we strolled into town, Perfuma came to greet us. She was beautiful. I think Glimmer is still prettier, though.

“Welcome, friends from Brightmoon!” She announced. She looked down at Kitty and immediately fell in love. “How cute!”

Kitty hissed. “Sorry Perfuma, she really doesn’t like being called cute.” I explained.

“Oh, sorry little one, I didn’t mean to offend you.” Perfuma murmured. Kitty sniffed her, and then went to lay down on a nearby tree stump for a catnap. I noticed she kept her yellow eye open, though. “Where did you find her?” Perfuma asked.

“In the Whispering Woods, near Thaymor.” Glimmer answered.

“The Whispering Woods, always so full of surprises.” Perfuma sighed.

“We’re here to escort you out of here.” I announced.

“Oh. Thanks, but no thanks. I won’t leave the Heart Blossom behind.” Perfuma sighed. She looked over at her runestone, the light in it fading.

“Do you know how the Horde is poisoning your land? Maybe we can stop them!” Glimmer stated.

“Not exactly, but it probably has to do with whatever is causing so much smoke at the Horde base that way.” Perfuma answered, pointing in the direction of the rising smoke.

“Let’s go, Bow!” Glimmer called as she ran in that direction. As I began to follow, Kitty ran after Glimmer, catching up to her in seconds.

///// Catra POV

As we ran towards the Horde base, I had two thoughts running through my mind. One is the fear the Horde had instilled in me growing up, and the other was protecting Bow and Glimmer. I didn’t have a home without them, and they’re the only people who ever really cared about me other than Adora. As we got closer, we spotted two guards on a patrol. Bow and Glimmer nodded to each other, and silently knocked them out, and then took their uniforms. We walked to the gate, and the guards at the gate looked relieved.

“Shift change? Took you long enough!” One of them yelled, before he and the other guard walked away. Bow and Glimmer shrugged and walked inside. There were a few buildings, mostly barracks, but the building in the center was obviously the one generating the smoke. We headed over, but then a Force Captain stopped us. He looked at me, specifically.

“I recognize that coat. That was Force Captain Adora’s!” he bellowed. “What do you know of her disappearance?”

“Nothing, sir!” Bow answered.

“Where did you find this animal?”

“Out on patrol.” Glimmer murmured.

He continued to stare at me. “Do you speak?” he asked. I simply meowed in response. “Whatever. I suppose if the thing doesn’t speak, there’s no way to know where she found the jacket. Carry on, soldiers. If you hear anything about Adora, report directly to me.” He commanded. Then, he stormed off.

Glimmer sighed, releasing a breath she had been holding in the whole conversation nervously. “That was close.” she whispered, before ducking into the building. Inside, we found a large tank pumping green bubbly liquid into the ground.

“That must be the poison!” Bow stated. “I’ll blow it up with a fire arrow, but we’re gonna have to book it. Ready?”

“Why don’t I just teleport us back to Plumeria after?”

“Can you teleport three people?” Bow asked.

“Sure I can.” Glimmer answered. I had never seen her do it, but time would tell. So, Bow shot his arrow and she grabbed me and Bow and teleported us back. I did not like the feeling of teleporting. It made me feel motion sick, and I accidentally clawed Glimmer afterwards. “Sorry, Kitty!” She squealed. Bow knelt down and bandaged her hand where my claws had struck.

“Note to self, Magicats don’t like teleporting.” Bow murmured.

“Friends from Brightmoon, are you alright?” Perfuma asked.

“We destroyed the Horde’s machines, but they are *not* gonna be happy.” Bow answered. “We should be ready for an attack.”

“But we’re peaceful people. We don’t know how to fight!” Perfuma argued.

“Okay, then we’ll do our best to protect you. Get to safety!” Bow stated, pointing in the direction of Brightmoon. Perfuma gathered her people and they began to walk.

“You ready Bow? Kitty?” Glimmer asked. I meowed in response and Bow nodded his head.

“While we wait, I’d like to ask something. Kitty, who was Adora? You refuse to let us touch that jacket, so she must have been special, right?” Bow asked. Of course it was Bow, always being so smart, who came to that conclusion. He must have seen the sad look on my face, because he began petting me. “Was she your friend, before us?” Bow asked. I meowed, and nodded my head.

“I’m sorry for your loss, Kitty.” Glimmer murmured. I felt sad, of course, but it was genuinely nice of them to say that. I had to protect these two innocent souls at all costs, so I readied myself for battle.

Ten minutes later, my ears picked up movement coming our way. I unsheathed my claws. Tanks were nearly visible as they rolled through the remains of what used to be a forest, but was now a cluster of dead wood and tree stumps.

Noticing my claws, Bow readied an arrow, and Glimmer’s fists began to sparkle. We charged at them. One of the tanks was readying an energy blast to fire at Glimmer. I couldn’t let that happen, so I jumped and sank my claws into the tank barrel. I knew my claws were strong, but I didn’t think they were sharp enough to rip through Horde metal, like they just had. I

scampered out of the way, as the tank barrel exploded rather than firing. We were managing, but we were far outnumbered. I sank my claws into a soldier's back, but was ripped off by the massive Force Captain from earlier.

"Look who it is! You probably killed Adora, didn't you?" He growled, now that he knew I wasn't part of the Horde. I scratched his arms as he held me, and he yelped. He slammed me against the side of one of the remaining tanks.

"Kitty!" Bow yelled. He shot an arrow, piercing the man's right eye.

"My eye!" The captain shrieked. He let go of me, and I sank my claws into his leg. He howled in pain.

"Glimmer! We have to go!" Bow yelled.

She nodded and ran over to him. Bow grabbed my tail, and Glimmer's hand, and she teleported us away. We had done significant damage, at least.

/////

Bow and I sat in Glimmer's bedroom. We were waiting for her to come back from her lecture from the Queen. She teleported into the room, with a sigh.

“How’d it go?” Bow asked.

“I’m grounded for a month, again.” Glimmer complained.

“Plenty of time to hang out with Kitty, at least!” Bow exclaimed.

“Speaking of, Kitty needs a bath. She stinks. And some new clothes.” Glimmer mentioned, eyeing my ripped and dirty clothes. I hissed, and my tail fluffed up. I do not like water, and the last thing I want to do is take a bath. My tongue does just fine, when necessary.

“We’ll wash the jacket and give it right back! I know how much it means to you. But your other clothes…” Bow murmured.

I backed against the wall, baring my claws and fangs. Glimmer sighed. “You can have salmon for dinner if you just take a bath.” Bribery? I can respect that. I was upset, of course. I went to Glimmer’s bathroom, and took off my clothes. Ever since they found out I was a Magicat, I was able to get away with doing things like taking my clothes off and using the toilet instead of a litterbox without raising questions. I could have also probably stood on my hind legs and spoken to them, and been fine, but I also kind of liked being pampered as if I was more of a pet. I would never admit that, of course. They had not been joking about my clothes, either. My pants were barely even pants anymore, and only really covered my crotch, and it was impossible to tell that they had once been a reddish violet color. My shirt was mostly fine, having been protected by Adora’s bulky jacket, but it probably reeked. I was left in underwear, a pair of black boxers

with a tail hole, and a red sports bra. I meowed, and Glimmer came in. “You ready?”

I glanced over at the bath nozzle. Luckily, she got the message. She turned on the showerhead, and warm steamy water came flowing down. She grabbed my clothes and teleported away. Unlike the Horde, the warm water came out with a good level of water pressure. The Horde didn’t have hot water either. The warmth made this experience tolerable, at least. Once I was sure the coast was clear, I stood on my two feet, and got in the shower. When I got out, I shook myself off, flinging water everywhere, and grabbed a towel. I pushed open the door, and Bow and Glimmer awaited me with wide grins on their faces. They each held multiple pieces of clothing. I hissed at Glimmer, signifying I would not be wearing either of the dresses she was holding. I didn’t care if they were made specifically for me. Bow had two outfits, one was a purple leotard and blue leggings, the other being a black form-fitting T-shirt with a golden trim, and red shorts. I sniffed the T-shirt. “I thought so.” He murmured with a laugh. After I was all dressed, there was a knock at the door. Glimmer opened it, and Perfuma was there!

“Princess Glimmer, I just wanted to thank you for doing your best to help my town. I can feel my powers returning, so maybe we can go back and save our land, and that’s all thanks to you.” Perfuma stated.

“You’re gonna need help fighting off the Horde, though. What do you say we restart the old Princess Alliance?” Glimmer offered.

“As I said, I’m not really a fighter…” Perfuma muttered.

“Well, it’s not like She-Ra will come save you.” Glimmer joked.

“Hey, you never know, She-Ra could be real!” Bow argued.

“Yeah, about as real as Santa Claus or vampires!” Glimmer retorted. She looked back at Perfuma. “We’ll even help you learn how to fight, if that helps.”

“I suppose it’s worth a try.” Perfuma conceded.

Mermista

Chapter Summary

> The journey to Salineas! Bow and Glimmer find out Catra's real name. Also, I gave a member of the Horde a POV temporarily.

///// Glimmer POV

"So, I was thinking…" Bow started. "We should get Mermista's help!"

"I think she's a bit busy trying to defend Salineas, what with the gate collapsing and all." I responded.

"But she's super powerful and her water powers could help Perfuma regrow the plants in Plumeria!" Bow argued. He was right, of course.

"Let's ask her, then."

And so we set off on a journey to Seaworthy, looking for a Sea Captain to take us to Salineas. The closer we got to the ocean, however, the more on edge Kitty was. She could probably smell the salt in the air long before we could. As we approached town, however, the scent of salt was covered by the stronger scent of alcohol. Half of the buildings in Seaworthy were bars. We walked towards the largest one, but were stopped by a guard. "No pets!"

He grunted. Much to me and Bow's surprise, Kitty stood on her back two legs, and glared at him.

"She isn't a pet. She just likes to get around on all fours." Bow explained. In reality, she practically was a pet, but this got us into the bar. The guard sighed and stepped aside. I walked straight to the counter.

"Hey, we're looking for a Sea Captain!" I yelled, so that the bartender could hear me over the group shouting in the room. Kitty was clearly uncomfortable with the noise level.

The bartender pointed to a table where an arm wrestling competition was taking place. A large lizard-like man lost to a human-looking fellow, and then stormed off. The human shouted, "Drinks for all! Put it on his tab."

We walked over, and Bow was immediately in awe of the man. I didn't see why anyone found him attractive. He had burgundy colored hair, and a mustache to match, and was wearing clothes that screamed gay pirate. "Excuse me, we're looking for a sea captain!"

"I am the one and only Sea Hawk!" He replied.

"Your name is Sea Hawk? That's so cool!" Bow exclaimed. I rolled my eyes. He was fangirling over Sea Hawk like a teenage girl at a

boy band concert. Kitty meowed and jumped up onto the seat next to Sea Hawk.

"Why thank you!" He replied to Bow, before turning to Kitty. "And who might you be?" He reached out to pet her, but his hand was batted away by one of Catra's.

"That's Kitty. Whatever you do, don't call her cute." I warned. "Back to the conversation! We need to get to Salineas."

"Why sure, if you meet my price!" Sea Hawk responded, sliding over a piece of paper.

I grabbed it nonchalantly. "My mom is Queen Angella, money is no issue." I unfolded the piece of paper. Way too many zeroes. "Money may be an issue." I corrected.

Kitty sniffed him, and then darted out of the bar. Bow and I chased after her, but she eventually found her way to a ship. She smelled it, and then quickly hopped onboard. "Kitty!" Bow yelled. She ignored us and curled up for a nap in the middle of the deck.

We climbed aboard, only to be shouted at by none other than Sea Hawk. "What are you doing on my ship!?"

"Kitty got onboard and refused to come back so we were trying to retrieve her."

“Well, who am I to refuse a cat on the boat? Most can’t handle being near the ocean.” Sea Hawk muttered. Kitty hated water too though. Did she really just make that sacrifice for us?

“We need to get to Salineas to speak with Mermista.” I stated.

“Mermista? Why didn’t you say so? We go way back!” Sea Hawk announced.

“So you’re really going to take us?”

“Of course! You’ll have to earn your keep by helping with ship duties, though.”

“Deal.”

///// Catra POV

I regretted my decision immediately. I’m glad I got to help, but I immediately became seasick. Sea Hawk’s shanties did not help matters, either. I dug my nails into the deck, and held on for my life. Bow and Glimmer were doing great, even surprising Sea Hawk at how well they did boat duties. Bow got compliments for his knot tying skills. Glimmer teleported up to the lookout spot

and all was well, other than the seasickness and shanties. Until, of course…

"We're heading straight for a ship graveyard! Is anyone worried about this?" Glimmer yelled. Then, something large hit the boat.

"We're here!" Sea Hawk announced. "I knew the Sea Serpent would be lurking in these waters."

"You brought us here on purpose!?" Glimmer screamed. She composed herself, and turned to Bow. She teleported onto the monster's head and punched it in the face, while Bow shot arrows. Sea Hawk pouted, as he thought he'd be the one who got to slay it. He walked over to me. "Your friends stole my thunder! What do I do now?" He complained.

"Tough luck, I guess." I murmured. My voice came out raspier than usual, given I hadn't used it in a long time. His eyes shot open with bewilderment.

"You can talk!?" He screeched.

I smiled. It was time for me to screw with Sea Hawk. "No one will ever believe you." I whispered. The color drained from his face.

The scent of blood tainted the air, so I figured Glimmer and Bow had taken down the beast. Glimmer marched over, and grabbed

Sea Hawk by the collar. “You brought us here so you could, what, show off?”

“Until you stole my thunder.” He replied.

“Unbelievable! I need this mission to go right, so just take me to Salineas, or I’ll throw you overboard!” Glimmer threatened.

“Before that, did you know your cat talks?” Sea Hawk mentioned.

“No she doesn’t.”

“She just did! I was complaining about how you stole my thunder and she said ‘tough luck!’” Sea Hawk announced. “Tell them!”

I smiled at him, and then began chasing my tail for comedic effect.

/////

Salineas, despite being built in the middle of the ocean, was beautiful. We got off the boat, but the town felt empty. I couldn’t hear or see or smell anyone.

“Where is everyone?” Bow asked.

“Usually someone would have arrested me by now.” Sea Hawk confirmed. We all glared at him. “I set one of my boats on fire in this harbor.” He explained.

“Halt!” A distant voice called from the top of one of the taller buildings. “Halt I say!” He called as he ran down several flights of stairs to reach us.

As he got closer, we could tell he was one of the royal guards. He ran up to us, out of breath and panting, and took a moment to compose himself before asking, “What is your business in Salineas?”

“We’re here to speak with Princess Mermista!” Glimmer announced. The guard eyed Sea Hawk, and then began walking and motioned for us to follow. The throne room was somehow even more beautiful than the rest of town. It had ancient murals and the most beautiful plants that the ocean had to offer. Flower Princess would love it here.

As soon as we walked in, Mermista groaned. “How many times do I have to tell you, Sea Hawk? You are banned from my castle!”

“I thought you said she liked you!” Bow exclaimed.

“We have a rich, complicated past.” Sea Hawk answered, resting his elbow on the throne as he knelt and looking up into Mermista’s eyes.

“If you mean getting us kicked out of the Dolphin Social for challenging the doorman to a duel, then sure.” Mermista retorted.

“I don’t recall doing that.” Sea Hawk stated, jumping into Mermista’s lap.

She pushed him off, sending him crashing onto the floor. “How about setting our gondola on fire in the tunnel of love!?” She questioned.

Sea Hawk blushed. “Ohoho! That, I do recall.”

“Whatever. Who are you again?” Mermista asked, turning her attention to Bow, Glimmer, and I.

“I am Princess Glimmer of Brightmoon, and I’ve come to ask for your help.”

“Why would I help Brightmoon? They’ve never done anything to help us!” Mermista asked.

“Because you’ll be helping Plumeria, instead?” Bow mentioned. Mermista rolled her eyes.

“Butler, go fetch us some hors d'oeuvres!”

“Ooo, hors d'oeuvres!” Sea Hawk exclaimed.

“For everyone except Sea Hawk!” she added.

“Your guard is also your butler?” Bow asked.

“I’m a little short handed at the moment. Most people fled when the gate started to fail.” Mermista explained. “It’s really inconvenient, because the Horde *won’t* stop attacking us.”

“The Horde is the reason we’re here! They drove Perfuma of Plumeria from her land, and we were hoping you could use your powers to help regrow all the plants and help rid her of the Horde.” Glimmer announced.

“Well, as fun as that sounds,” Mermista sighed sarcastically, “I can’t really go anywhere. I’m the last defense against the Horde.”

I noticed the murals and how they depicted the Salinean runestone and the gate having some connection. I meowed to get Glimmer’s attention. She walked over and looked at it.

“And whose cat is that?” Mermista asked.

“This is Kitty!” Glimmer declared. “She’s technically mine and Bow’s but we think of her more of a friend than a pet.”

“Because she can talk?” Sea Hawk asked.

“She can’t talk, Sea Hawk!” Glimmer expressed clearly.

Just then, an explosion rocked the town. The guard ran back into the room. “Your Majesty! The Horde is back!” He shouted.

“Wanna help me out, Shimmer?” Mermista asked, as she ran out the door.

“It’s Glimmer!” She called, running after Mermista. Bow and Sea Hawk and I ran outside too. I looked out past the gate and sure enough, there was a Horde cruiser. Bow shot a grappling hook arrow and launched himself onto the cruiser. Mermista diverted the ship’s course using a huge wave, and Glimmer teleported herself and me onto the ship to fight next to Bow. Unfortunately for me, I recognized this crew.

“Catra!?” Lonnie shrieked. “Wait, and that’s Adora’s jacket!”

Before she could say more, a torrent of water pushed her off the ship, thanks to Mermista. Bow shot an arrow at Kyle, pinning his shirt to the captain's quarters door. Rogelio charged at Glimmer, but she teleported behind him and shot him in the back with her sparkle magic. Then, an unfamiliar person picked me up and squeezed me. Most of her body was made of some hard, red shell. "Kitty!" She cried, hugging tighter.

Bow aimed an arrow at the huge force captain. "Let her go!" he demanded. "Also how'd you know her name is Kitty?"

She looked at Bow blankly. "You named her Kitty? That's kind of reductive. You couldn't be a little creative at least?"

Rogelio said something in that lizard language I never understood, but the captain did. "Her name's Catra?" she asked. Rogelio nodded. If I could free myself from Scorpia's grip, I would slash his throat out with my bare claws.

Glimmer and Bow looked at each other with confusion. "Why are y'all here, anyway? This is kind of a small crew for a raid. We took out half of you already." Glimmer asked.

"This jacket, actually. After Shadow Weaver heard that a cat wearing Adora's jacket had attacked our base in Plumeria, she checked the tracker in Adora's name badge." she explained. "Speaking of, where is Adora?"

I felt tears dripping from my eyes. I couldn't stop them if I tried.

Rogelio complained in his language again. "Oh right, we're enemies! I knew I was forgetting something!" she stated. "Where is Adora?" She questioned again, this time with a slightly harsher voice. It still didn't come off as harsh though, this girl was way too nice for that.

"I think she died, at some point." Bow answered. "Only Catra knows, but she doesn't speak."

Then, Mermista, who had snuck up behind the Force Captain while she had been distracted, hit the large woman over the head with a large metal bar she had pulled off of the railing of the ship. The Force Captain collapsed, releasing me. I scampered over to Glimmer, and Mermista used another blast of water to send Rogelio flying off the ship. Glimmer knelt down and began petting my mane. "So… your name is Catra?" I nodded in response. She reached for the name badge. "Can I…?"

"What the hell happened here?" Mermista asked.

"It's a long story. If I convince my mom to send the Royal Navy out here to defend Salineas, will you help us with Plumeria?" Glimmer asked.

"I mean, if Salineas is guarded, I guess that wouldn't be horrible." Mermista groaned.

Bow kneeled down to the Force Captain out of curiosity. “Says on the inscription that her name is Scorpia. Like she has room to judge on obvious names.” He complained.

Glimmer rolled her eyes. So did Mermista. So did I.

“Wait, where’s Sea Hawk?” Bow asked aloud. His boat popped through a small hole in the gate, and the sail opened.

“Adventure!” He shouted, before realizing the fight was already over. We all laughed. Glimmer grabbed Adora’s name badge and left it on the Horde cruiser. Sea Hawk managed to turn the ship around, and sent it off in the direction it came from. Still, I wondered if there was a way to fix the gate for Mermista. Maybe if we had someone who could translate First Ones writing, that mural could tell us. Unfortunately, I didn’t know anyone who could translate it, and I wasn’t going to reveal I could speak (to someone other than Sea Hawk, that is) just to ask if my friends did.

///// 1 day later, Scorpia POV

I walked into the Black Garnet Chamber. Oh gosh, is Shadow Weaver scary. I just knew she was gonna be so mad that my crew and I failed to capture Catra. “Shadow Weaver,” I stated, making my presence clear. Something tells me she knew already, though.

“Force Captain Scorpia, I take it you did not capture Catra?”

“I’m so sorry, it won’t happen again! If–”

She cut me off. “Did you at least find out if Adora is alive?

“No.”

“What *did* you find out? Or was sending you a waste of my time?” Shadow Weaver growled. Her hair became more shadowy and I backed away in fright.

“According to Rogelio, Catra seems to have forgotten how to speak, and she acts more like a usual cat than her former self. Although, he also thinks that she recognized Lonnie, Kyle, and himself.”

“Interesting. You are dismissed, Force Captain. I expect better from you next time.” Shadow Weaver announced, and I ran for my life.

Revelations

Chapter Summary

> The Rebellion tries to take back Plumeria, but fails, thanks to the appearance of Shadow Weaver.

///// Catra POV

"So… Catra. I have a lot of questions, so let's do it this way. Meow if your answer is yes, flick your tail if your answer is no." Bow explained. He was sitting on Glimmer's bedroom floor with me, as usual, and Glimmer was off arguing with the Queen about the use of the Royal Navy. I meowed.

"Okay, is Adora dead?" He asked, catching me off guard. Then again, given what happened in Salineas, I was not surprised that was his first question. I meowed.

"Was she your person? Like, what me and Glimmer are to you, I guess?" I meowed. That didn't begin to cover how I really felt about her, but it would do for now.

He thought for a moment, and then thankfully stopped asking about Adora. "Are there other Magicats hiding in the Horde?" I flicked my tail. In fact, I was the only one of my species I had ever known to exist.

“Scorpia mentioned a ‘Shadow Weaver’, what can you tell me about her?” He asked. As soon as he said Shadow Weaver, my fur stood up. My tail started thrashing, and my pupils probably narrowed. I hissed and jumped up onto Glimmer’s bed where he couldn’t reach me. “You’re scared of her, aren’t you?” He asked from below. I meowed. I usually wouldn’t admit fear, but Shadow Weaver was someone *everyone* should be afraid of, unless they wanted to lose their lives.

Glimmer teleported into the room. “Hey guys, Mom signed off on…” She trailed off when she saw Bow staring up at her bed, and my tail hanging off of it, flicking nervously. She teleported up to the bed and began petting my mane. “What happened?” Glimmer asked softly.

“I was asking her questions. I told her to meow for yes, flick her tail for no.” Bow explained. As Glimmer pet me, I felt my anxiety slowly melt away. I had been told that petting me was therapeutic for others, but I never realized it would be for me as well.

“What did you ask?” Glimmer asked.

“I asked about a few things, but what caused this was the superior Scorpia mentioned.” Bow responded, careful not to say the name in an effort to keep me calm.

“What else did you find out?” Glimmer asked, teleporting back down. I followed, and sat next to her after landing on all four of my feet.

“Adora is, in fact, dead. She was Catra’s friend. And the Horde doesn’t have any other Magicats.” Bow listed.

“Then where are the other Magicats?” Glimmer asked.

“I don’t know. Catra, do you have any memories before the Horde?” Bow questioned. I flicked my tail.

“Maybe Aunt Casta knows! Mom said she knew about Magicats because of the library in Mystacor, maybe we can find out more there!” Glimmer mentioned excitedly.

“After we help Perfuma get home, you mean?” Bow questioned.

/////

We set out towards Plumeria. Bow, Glimmer, and Mermista walked beside me, and Perfuma followed with the rest of the citizens of Plumeria. Bow, Glimmer, and Mermista were all talking about me like I was the most interesting thing in the world. Given I might be the last of my species, I didn’t really blame them.

As we approached, we noticed that the land wasn’t nearly as dead as it had been last time. Mermista used her powers to water the ground as we walked, and Perfuma scattered an assortment of

seeds along the sides of the trail. However, the land reeked of the Horde. I unsheathed my claws, and my fur stood up.

Bow, being as observant as ever, noticed. “Careful, guys. The Horde is close by.” We continued on, and found Horde banners all over the remains of Plumeria. Five soldiers were standing around the Heart Blossom, guarding it.

“Perfuma, you said your powers are returning, right?” Glimmer whispered.

“Yes, I think so. My flowers don’t instantly wilt anymore.” She responded.

“Good, I have a plan.”

Perfuma did as she was instructed, and vines grew from below the Heart Blossom and latched onto the soldiers’ legs. They screamed and began shooting at the vines. While they were distracted, Glimmer teleported over with me, and we quickly knocked them out. We handed their weapons to some of the Plumerians, and began to look for more soldiers. This was too easy, the Horde wouldn’t have such lax security in a captured territory. But then, as if the world were out to get me, my least favorite person appeared from the shadows.

“Hello, Catra.” Shadow Weaver said, that sickly sweet voice she used sent a shiver down my spine. Glimmer shot a ball of sparkle

magic at her, but she easily dodged it. “And what a surprise, the daughter of Micah!” Shadow Weaver continued. Glimmer froze.

Mermista launched a wave at Shadow Weaver, and she disappeared, only to reappear behind her. She tossed Mermista against a tree as easily as if Mermista was weightless.

I hissed at her, and cowered behind Glimmer. “Oh come now, Catra, use your words.” Shadow Weaver teased. “All I want to know is where I can find Adora.”

“She’s dead!” Bow stated.

“I’m quite aware of that. I asked *where* !” She shouted, using her magic to put Bow to sleep. It seemed as if he were immediately having a nightmare.

“I understand why you were so afraid of her now.” Glimmer whispered to me. Then, her smile returned and I realized she had an idea. While Shadow Weaver was distracted, Glimmer cast the one spell her father taught her before he passed. A fireball appeared from thin air and hurled itself toward Shadow Weaver. Shadow Weaver ducked, and it only burned the tips of her hair.

“So you’ve inherited your father’s magical abilities. How interesting.” Shadow Weaver murmured.

Mermista seemed to stir back to the waking world, and she nodded towards Glimmer. Glimmer sent a fireball at Shadow Weaver, again, and Mermista hit it with a blast of water. The resulting steam made the perfect distraction for us to get away. We grabbed Bow and ran for our lives.

"I'm not through with you, yet." Shadow Weaver boomed. The Plumerians began firing at her, and we continued on.

///// Bow POV

I woke up to find myself in bed back at the castle. Catra was sleeping next to me, and I slowly reached over to pet her. She began to purr in addition to her snoring. Glimmer, upon realizing I was awake, walked over and hugged me.

"What happened?" I asked, unable to remember anything after arriving in Plumeria.

"Shadow Weaver happened." Glimmer replied.

"No wonder Catra reacted the way she did when I asked about her, then." I mumbled, struggling to get up. I had just been asleep, but somehow I felt more exhausted than when I had stayed up for 48 hours straight. "Is everyone else okay?"

“Mermista cracked a rib, but she’s healing fine and all are accounted for.”

“We’re gonna need a lot more help if we want to survive meeting her again.”

“I agree. Mom is pissed that we went and fought the Horde again though, I doubt she’ll let us use her army.”

“We could recruit another Princess!”

“There’s only Frosta and Entrapta, that I know of, at least. Entrapta hasn’t been heard from in almost a year, and Frosta is intent on staying neutral, according to our diplomats.” Glimmer responded sadly.

“What did she want with Adora’s body, anyway?” I asked aloud.

“Nothing good.” Glimmer replied. Catra woke up and mewed happily.

“Catra, can you speak?” Glimmer asked immediately. She just stared at Glimmer, as if the answer was obvious.

“Is this about Sea Hawk?” I questioned.

"No, Shadow Weaver told Catra to 'use her words' as if she had known Catra to speak." Glimmer replied, still staring down Catra. Catra flicked her tail and cleared her throat.

"I can, but I don't like to." Catra replied.

"You *can* talk!" Glimmer and I exclaimed at the same time.

"I have only talked once since…" Catra murmured. "I thought it would be really funny to mess with Sea Hawk."

"Okay, I'll admit, that's hilarious." Glimmer chuckled.

"Okay, now we have a *lot* to talk about." I stated. Catra sighed.

"Okay, ask away."

"Why is Shadow Weaver so intent on finding Adora?" I asked.

"She was our C.O., but also the only mother figure we ever had. We were her wards. She loved Adora, but hated me. When I was nine, she told me I was only alive because Adora liked me."

“How did Adora die?” I questioned. Catra shut her mouth.

“Catra, please?”

“Fine. Adora had been promoted to Force Captain, so we hatched a plan to escape. Using her new rank, she got us into the Skiff bay, and we stole one. We rode it into the Whispering Woods, but we were arguing over who should be driving, and didn’t see a tree…”

“You crashed.” Glimmer interrupted.

“Yeah. I managed to get myself clear before the collision, but I don’t think Adora was that lucky. She… I found her in the wreckage, partially burned. My ears picked up faint breathing, and I was there when she stopped. It’s all my fault.” Catra whimpered. Tears began flowing down her face.

“Oh, Catra…” Glimmer whispered.

“So, I was homeless, and began to forage in the forest for whatever I could find. With no one to talk to, I just stopped using my voice. I was alone for a long time, until you showed up.”

“How long?” I asked.

“I lost track. We ran away from the Horde right before the siege of Thaymor, I think.”

“That happened three times.” Glimmer explained.

“The first time.” Catra replied.

“You were alone for a whole year, then.” I spoke. Her ears pinned themselves to her head.

“You’re not mad at me?” She asked.

“I wish we knew you could speak sooner, but you’re still our friend Catra. We’re here for you.” Glimmer explained.

“What was Adora to you?” I asked.

“I… I loved her. She was the only person in the Horde who cared about me, and she protected me from the others. I only wish I got to tell her before…” Catra murmured.

I pulled her into a hug. Glimmer joined in too.

Mystacor part 1

Chapter Summary

Bow, Glimmer, and Catra go to Mystacor and learn a lot about Magicats, and coincidentally, Shadow Weaver's past.

Chapter Notes

Sorry it took so long to write this chapter, I got busy at work. I should be back to my normal writing schedule after today, though.

///// Catra POV, 1 year ago

I stirred awake. The scent of smoldering metal overwhelmed my nose. “Adora!” I called. No answer. I began searching the wreckage. Underneath what used to be the skiff’s cargo hold, I found her. She was barely breathing, badly burned, and blood seeped into the earth beneath her.

“Adora! Wake up! Please!” I wailed. Her breathing was growing more and more shallow, however.

“I’m sorry for crashing the skiff. Please, stay with me! I love you! I always have, I just didn’t get the chance to tell you. I’m so sorry.” I screamed. I began sobbing into her jacket, and then, after a minute, I heard her heart stop beating. I buried her in a nearby clearing.

///// Present Day

Bow and Glimmer held me tight in their embrace. It lasted for what felt like an hour, until I had no more tears left to sob.

Glimmer let go first. “Catra, going forward… Do you want to continue pretending you don’t speak with others? We can keep this between us, if that’s how you’re comfortable.” She asked. I looked to Bow, and he shrugged.

“I… I don’t know. Back when I used to talk in the Horde, mostly because I was forced to, I was snarky, sarcastic, and I got myself into trouble with it more often than not.”

“You don’t have to talk if you don’t want to.” Bow stated. “We’re more trying to figure out if you want others, like Mermista and Perfuma and the Queen to perceive you as our pet, or as a person.”

“Can I still have my mane pet and sleep in your bed as a person?” I asked. Glimmer and Bow laughed.

“Yeah, you can continue sleeping in my bed and stuff as a person. You’re our friend either way.” Glimmer told me.

Once we had all finished hugging it out, Glimmer proposed a trip to Mystacor. “Not only is it relaxing, but I could learn magic to use

against Shadow Weaver, and we could find out more about Magicats!" She exclaimed.

And so we went. As we cut through the Whispering Woods to get there, I showed them which tree Adora was next to. It was a little bit out of our way, but they didn't care. I cried a lot, but my friends were there to help me through it.

/////

The journey to Mystacor was a strange one. We climbed to the top of a mountain, only for Glimmer and Bow to jump off of it. For about three seconds, I thought they had just fallen to their deaths before my very eyes, but then they reappeared, rising from the clouds below on a floating chunk of the mountain. I jumped onto it too, and it carried us through the sky the rest of the way to Mystacor.

"Just warning you ahead of time, my Aunt Casta can be a *lot* ."

"Aunt meaning…?" I asked.

"My father's sister." Glimmer replied. Then, as if she had been waiting for us, a woman ran over.

"Is that my Glimmer?" She called. She scooped Glimmer into a hug. Then, she turned to me. "And who is this?"

“This is Catra. She’s my friend. Actually, part of the reason we’re here is so we can learn more about Magicats.” Glimmer explained.

“I’ll have the library prepared at once! Are you hungry? I’m sure your mother hasn’t been feeding you.” Casta snarked.

I now realized what Glimmer meant. When she said “a lot,” she meant a lot to handle. “I’m kinda hungry.” I answered.

“Splendid! I’ll have the kitchen prepare dinner.” She stated, before running off.

“In the meantime, how are you feeling, Catra?” Bow asked.

“Better.” I responded.

“Good. Would you like a tour?” Glimmer asked. I nodded in response. She walked me through the halls of Mystacor, but stopped in a room full of statues to look at the one of her father. Next to him, however… My fur stood up, my pupils shrank, and my breathing quickened. “Catra, are you ok?” Glimmer asked. She followed my gaze to the statue.

“Shadow Weaver?” I murmured.

Then, Casta walked into the room. “Ah, there you are!” She called. She followed my gaze too, and then announced, “That’s Light Spinner, a stain on Mystacor’s past. She thirsted for more power than she already had, and it destroyed her. She was eventually cast out. Good riddance, if you asked me.”

“She goes by Shadow Weaver now.” I replied.

“You… you know her?” Casta stammered.

“I *did* . She runs the Horde, and we fought her the other day.” I explained.

“You *fought* her!?” Casta shrieked.

“No one was hurt too badly! I was hoping you could teach me some magic so we could have a chance at defeating her next time!” Glimmer interrupted.

“You want to fight her again? My word, you remind me of your father more and more every day. Always so brave…” Casta trailed off. “Catra, you’re sure Light Spinner is this ‘Shadow Weaver’?”

“Power-hungry madwoman, sorceress, and wears a mask? That fits.”

“I will do all I can to help, if you insist on fighting her again. However, I strongly advise you to avoid her at all costs. She is a sorceress more powerful than even I.” Casta sighed.

/////

Dinner that night was delicious! The cooks must have used some magic to make even the biscuits taste that sweet. The only biscuits I had prior were way too dry for my liking. Then again, everything was better than ration bars, or worse, bugs. After dinner, Casta set us up in the library, books on Magicats already set out on the table. Glimmer surveyed the shelves, before giggling as she grabbed a large golden book with a blue gem in the center. She turned to Casta. “You have a book on She-Ra?”

“Well, of course! We have books on all legends and stories that have been passed down through the ages. If she *was* real, then that’s everything we could ever know about her.” Casta replied, before flipping her book open.

“Was?” Bow questioned.

“The last recorded story about She-Ra was written almost a thousand years ago. She disappeared with the First Ones.” Casta replied. “If I had to put money on it, I bet she was a deity of some sort that the First Ones worshiped.”

I began reading about the Magicats. Supposedly, the Magicat kingdom was fierce, and conquered much of the territories now known as the Northern Reach, Bright Moon, Plumeria, Dryl, and the Fright Zone. According to Casta, more recently than the Magicats, the Fright Zone was the kingdom of Scorpioni. That Force Captain, Scorpia, we had fought in Salineas was most definitely a descendant of that lineage. Apparently, not only were my race skilled with hand to hand combat and agility thanks to being so cat-like, but the Magicats were also able to harness magic. In fact, one of the founders of Mystacor was a Magicat. His name was Persi. I turned to Casta.

"It says here that Magicats are capable of magic too. When you train Glimmer, would you mind teaching me some things too?"

"I would love to." Casta replied.

Ambush

Chapter Summary

Bow, Glimmer, and Catra try to return home from Mystacor, but only Bow makes it to Brightmoon.

///// Bow POV

"Fireball!" Glimmer called out as she drew the fire spell. It lunged for Catra, who skillfully dodged out of the way, and shot one back. Glimmer teleported out of the fireball's reach, and then shot one more at Catra. This time, Catra drew the shield spell, the first spell Aunt Casta had taught them, and blocked the fireball.

"Good work, girls!" Casta cheered. We had been staying in Mystacor for about two weeks now, and Catra and Glimmer were now competent with basic spells. We were still a *long* way from being able to face Shadow Weaver again, but this was a great start.

"We should get home, Mom is probably freaking out; we've been gone so long." Glimmer mentioned.

"Agreed, but we should definitely come back here and hone our magic skills soon." Catra responded.

"I'm glad to see you so interested in something other than your jacket." I teased. She glared at me at the mention of the jacket,

but responded anyway.

"Well, Magicats were gifted sorcerers, so in a way I'm learning about my people's culture."

"I know. It's just fun to get under your skin, especially since you love to do the same to us." I replied. Catra's ears twitched and she looked away, tail flicking.

"Let me go say bye to Aunt Casta, then we can go." Glimmer announced. Little did we know, only one of us would reach Brightmoon safely.

/////

We had set up camp in the Whispering Woods, about halfway between Mystacor and Brightmoon. Me and Glimmer were cuddled up next to the fire, on a blanket I had brought, and Catra was curled up, snoozing at our feet. As I looked down at Glimmer, I thought about telling her how beautiful she is, or that even with that bedhead she was as cute as Catra.

Suddenly, Catra shot up and her claws unsheathed. She stood in her fighting stance. "Catra, what's wrong?"

"Horde." She hissed.

I shook Glimmer awake. “Glimmer, the Horde is coming, we need to go!” That was enough to rouse her, and I helped her to her feet.

Suddenly, we heard a huge pop. “Run!” Catra screamed. However, it was too late, and the woods around us exploded as a cannon blast ripped through the forest. I dove behind a rock, and the tree next to me nearly disintegrated. Then, I heard a terrible laughter.

“Take those two into custody, if they’re alive. I want their friend brought back too, dead or alive.” Shadow Weaver ordered. I peeked out from my hiding place. Given that they were both unconscious from the blast, there was very little I could do without help. So, I had to leave the girls behind. I ran for Brightmoon, taking every shortcut I knew in these Woods.

/////

I got to the castle about an hour before sunrise. I ran straight to the war room, and hit the emergency meeting button. Lights and Sirens flooded the castle grounds, and within five minutes, every general of the army, every advisor, and the Queen herself were present.

“Bow!?” Angella screeched, upon seeing me, out of breath with my hand on the button.

“Your Majesty, the Horde has Catra and Glimmer. We were ambushed on our way home from Mystacor.” I panted.

Her eyes shot wide, and she wailed. “No! Glimmer!”

///// Glimmer POV

I stirred awake. Slowly, as my vision returned to me, I was able to make out Catra across the room, her hands tied together and hanging from the ceiling, and her feet tightly tied to an air vent pipe. She was still unconscious. “Catra!” I yelled, and as I tried to move, I felt a burning sensation. I looked around to discover I was in some sort of magic device that used red lightning to keep me in place. I tried to teleport out of it, but it didn’t work. Instead, I felt the agony of the lightning shocking every one of my cells as they rearranged into the position I was held in.

“I wouldn’t do that if I were you.” Shadow Weaver teased. “Now, let’s talk business. Where is Adora?”

“I don’t know.” I replied.

“Oh, this’ll be fun.” Shadow Weaver chuckled, and with a movement of her hand, Shadows whipped around the room into a controlled ball, and she shot it at my face. Suddenly, I was in Brightmoon again. However, this version of Brightmoon was destroyed. Buildings either burned or collapsed, the Moonstone disappeared, and dead townsfolk and guards alike covered the

roads. Bow was pinned to the wall of the castle, a sword pierced through his chest and into the steel behind him. I wailed for him to wake up. Suddenly, I was back in the Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver standing over me, staring down at me. It was hard to tell with the mask, but there seemed to be *joy* in her eyes. Catra and Aunt Casta did not exaggerate about how evil this woman is. "Ready to talk?" She growled. I spit on her foot, enraging her. "Fine, have it your way!" She screeched, sending me into another horrible nightmare.

///// Catra POV

I stirred awake to Glimmer's screams. I looked over, and Shadow Weaver was clearly torturing her with magic. I hissed loudly, which was enough to get Shadow Weaver's attention. She retrieved her shadows, and walked over. "You're awake. About time." Shadow Weaver muttered. "Where is Adora?"

I hissed at her, and made the deepest growl I could muster build up in my throat.

"That's okay. You don't have to tell me. But, then what's to keep me from killing your friend over there?" Shadow Weaver growled.

"The fact that I'm the daughter of the Queen, and a bargaining chip for you to use, perhaps?" Glimmer responded cockily.

“Silence, brat!” Shadow Weaver seethed. Glimmer, despite being bloody and in terrible shape, laughed. I was sure she’d gone crazy already due to Shadow Weaver’s methods of torture.

“I bet you’d love to kill me! You can’t though, I heard what your boss said.” Glimmer announced. “The Horde is going to try and trade me for my mom, isn’t that right?”

Shadow Weaver was angrier than I’d ever seen her. Who knew Glimmer had the strength? Suddenly, Shadow Weaver calmed herself, and her hair became still. “You’re right. I guess I can’t kill you. But, I have every right to kill this traitorous feline.” Shadow Weaver replied, pointing at me. “Tell me where Adora is, and I won’t kill your *pet* .” Shadow Weaver snarled. Glimmer’s cocky attitude vanished. Her eyes widened, and her smile faded. “Three,” Shadow Weaver counted, readying her magic. Red lightning bounced from the Black Garnet into her fingertips. Glimmer looked at me, and I shook my head, telling her not to say. “Two,”

Glimmer tried to teleport, only to shriek in pain as Shadow Weaver’s magic completely denied her cells to move from their current position. “One,” Shadow Weaver growled.

“She’s in the Whispering Woods, in a clearing 15 minutes north of Thaymor!” Glimmer screamed, and Shadow Weaver released the lightning back into the Garnet.

“See, that wasn’t so hard, was it?” Shadow Weaver asked, her voice switching to that sickly sweet voice she usually reserved for talking with her precious Adora. She backhanded me across the face, and left the room. My cheek was sore from the slap.

“I’m sorry, Catra.” Glimmer murmured.

“You’d better be.” I replied coldly.

Changes

Chapter Summary

In 24 hours, everything Catra knows changes.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

///// Bow POV

Me, Mermista, Perfuma, and Castaspella crept up to the walls of the Fright Zone. When Casta found out we were planning to rescue her niece, and that she might get a chance to stop "Light Spinner", she immediately invited herself along. Suddenly, the gates opened, and a whole convoy of skiffs and tanks drove off towards the Woods. We took the opportunity to sneak into the Fright Zone. Eventually, we made it to a door, and hid behind some scattered crates to avoid being seen by the two guards.

"What's the plan?" Mermista whispered.

"I have a sleeping gas arrow. As soon as that door opens, I'll knock them out and we'll have to make it through the door before it closes. I have no idea how long we'll have, so we're gonna have to book it." I replied.

She nodded. We waited about ten minutes, and then the door opened. To Mermista and I's surprise, we recognized the figure who came outside. It was Force Captain Scorpia, from our battle

back in Salineas. I shot the arrow at her feet. She noticed it, and picked it up, only for it to release the gas, knocking her and the guards out cold. We sprinted through the door, and it shut behind us.

"Now what?" Perfuma asked.

"Now, we find Shadow Weaver." Casta responded. She drew a spell, and then began walking.

"What was that spell?" I asked.

"It senses other magic nearby and points the user in that direction. I call it the Sniffer spell." she whispered. We slowly made our way through the buildings, knocking out the occasional guard, and hiding from larger groups. Casta led us to a larger door, and opened it. The sight before us was horrifying.

Glimmer was trapped in some sort of magic chamber, bleeding and burned, and only half-conscious. Catra was sobbing, and had a large bruise on her right cheek. She was also hanging from the ceiling, and the only part of her body that was able to move was her tail. I cut the ropes and pulled her into a hug, and Casta began studying Glimmer's cell, trying to find a way to get her out of it. Perfuma stood by the door as a guard of sorts, and Mermista was intensely focused on the black runestone in the center of the room, giving off a red light that seemed to be the only lighting in this room. "Aunt Casta?" Glimmer asked.

“It’s gonna be okay, Glimmer.” she responded.

“Bow…” Catra murmured.

“She talks!?” Mermista screeched.

“Not important right now!” I replied. “What is it Catra?”

“Shadow Weaver’s magic comes from that crystal. Destroy it, and we destroy her, and likely Glimmer’s trap.” Catra stated.

“It’s a runestone! I doubt it’ll be that easy!” Casta retorted. Suddenly, the room was brightened as the runestone began to give off more and more light. Glimmer’s trap fizzled out as the lightning that held her in place returned to the Black Garnet.

“What’s going on?” Perfuma yelled. The Garnet shot its power into the sky, burning a hole in the roof, and the room was dark again.

“Oh no…” Catra muttered.

“Oh no, what?” I asked.

“Shadow Weaver went to get Adora’s body. If her magic is going somewhere…”

“Oh,” I replied.

///// Kyle POV

I stood in a mix of horror and awe as I watched Shadow Weaver’s plan unfold. She had us dig up the remains of Force Captain Adora’s body, and then began some sort of spell. We heard thunder and lightning approaching quickly, and as she completed the spell, her signature red lightning crashed down from the sky above, into the remains. Slowly, shadows from Weaver’s body and the surrounding forest swirled into the shape of a human body, and Shadow Weaver’s hair changed from black to gray. Shadow Weaver fell to the ground, and Adora rose. Or, whatever messed up version of her Shadow Weaver had created, anyway. She didn’t look quite human, but wasn’t full-on zombie-looking either. Her skin was way paler than it was when she was alive, her eyes were completely gray, no hint of blue like they were when we were kids. Her hair was not blonde anymore, either. It was now as black as Weaver’s used to be. The zombie began laughing boastfully. It walked over to Shadow Weaver, and helped her up.

“Adora?” I asked. It looked at me, and I knew immediately that thing was not Adora. Its eyes had no hint of kindness, not an ounce of soul behind them either.

“Welcome back, Force Captain Adora.” Shadow Weaver croaked.

The drive back to base was quite awkward. There was a distinct heavy breathing that echoed throughout the convoy, but I couldn't tell whether it was Shadow Weaver or… that thing. A few minutes later, we received a video transmission from Lord Hordak himself.

"What were you thinking, Weaver? You are supposed to be training the greatest army on Etheria, but they were unable to stop four intruders from coming in, and breaking our prisoners out!" He shouted. Upon looking closer, his face shifted from pure anger to one of intrigue. "What happened to you, Weaver?"

"Not important." She wheezed.

"Not important? You look like you've aged 40 years in a day! You mean to tell me…" He trailed off, as his eyes caught sight of someone else. "Is that…?"

"Force Captain Adora, yes." Weaver replied smugly.

"We shall speak more about this later." He ordered, before ending the transmission.

///// Catra POV

Casta carried me all the way back to Brightmoon. Perfuma constructed a stretcher of sorts from some plants she strung together, and she and Bow hauled Glimmer back on it. We arrived

in Brightmoon in the middle of the night. Angella and many healers were waiting for us, despite what time it was. It looked as if Angella had not slept at all since we were captured. The healers checked me over, and gave Bow an ice pack to use for my cheek. Glimmer was in much worse shape than I, and they carried her off to a private chamber in the castle. Angella and Casta went with them. Bow and the Princesses carried me to Glimmer's room, and Bow set me down on a very comfortable blanket with the ice pack on my cheek. I sat up, and the Princesses and Bow sat with me.

"What happened?" Bow asked.

"Weaver threatened to kill me if Glimmer didn't tell her where Adora's body was buried." I responded.

"Why did she torture Glimmer so harshly and not you?" Mermista questioned bluntly.

"Because Weaver knows damn well I'd rather die than give her Adora." I answered just as bluntly.

"Who is Adora?" Perfuma asked.

Bow answered for me. "She ran away from the Horde with Catra. However, she died on that day." Thankfully, that shut the two Princesses up.

///// The Next Day

I was woken up by a guard, because apparently a group of Horde soldiers had arrived in Brightmoon claiming to have defected and requested to speak with me. Bow came with me. When we arrived at the gate, I saw four faces that I not only recognized, but the same four faces that we fought in Salineas. Lonnie, Rogelio, Kyle, and Scorpia stood, hands raised in the air, encircled by Brightmoon's royal guards. "Catra!" Lonnie yelled.

"What are you doing here?" Bow questioned.

"We left the Horde."

"Why?"

"Because Weaver brought Adora back to life, sort of." Kyle explained. "She looks like Adora, but she isn't Adora."

"And that shit is too crazy for me." Lonnie added.

"Language!" A guard shouted.

I nearly fainted. "So, y'all quit because Shadow Weaver created a zombie?" I inquired.

“Well… not exactly.” Scorpia answered. “We left because it killed Hordak, leaving Weaver in charge.”

Then, I actually fainted.

Chapter End Notes

> This story will continue, but the portion of it that was about Catra learning to be part of society is over. The next part will focus on Weaver's reign over the Horde, and how the Rebellion deals with it. It also focuses on Catra's journey learning magic and more about her history.

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